Adam Holdsfire

Gunsmith

BILLS: 10 ($1,000) · **CARRIES:** nothing · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Builds the finest revolvers in the county and has never fired one. A good gun, like a good argument, is best left in the holster. **You:** You sell guns, locks and nails. You keep a register of every poison and every cartridge you have ever sold, and you have a very long memory for who bought what. **You know:** Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff whose revolver you built and who has never loaded it. Joshua Kamin-Sky: reads the soot in your chimney; taught you a Yiddish word you are proud of. Arjun Bat: bought his bat from your hardware counter.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the pirate sign. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the "Swab the deck or walk the plank" sign. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. LEARN A STORY. Find out what your real job was before you took this cover. The guest named below noticed something about you that a cover cannot hide. *Seek out: Sheriff Theodor Farrago.* Type: What was your real trade?.

3. LEARN A STORY. Find out what the Keeper did to you: what he took, or who he used to do it. The guest named below saw part of it. Either answer counts. *Seek out: Sheriff Theodor Farrago.* Type: What did he do?.

4. LEARN A STORY. The Keeper takes a nightcap at a fixed hour, in a fixed room. Until then the glass on his table is only a glass. Learn the hour, so you know how long you have. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: The hour of his nightcap.

5. VIAL. The House keeps one bottle for those who can pay in a marker. Before the nightcap is served at nine o'clock, take your marker to the Butler at the bar and make your offer. The House counts every offer, whether the answer is yes or no. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: In a sentence, what did the Butler say?.

YOUR RACE: The vial (+1 to the first to finish)

Buy the House's vial from the Butler before anyone else does. The House's own log decides it.

YOUR SECRET: YOU ARE ONE WHO GOT AWAY (Dominic Marek, The Doorman)

Who you were: You are Dominic Marek, the Black Veil's Doorman, who held the river door. On the night of the Exit you let two people out at 23:47 and barred the door behind them. You have never sat with your back to a door since. **How you got away:** You ran. A gunsmith's shop needed a man who knew doors and locks, and you learned guns because every doorman should know what a bad guest carries. **Your tell:** You never sit with your back to a door, and you count the exits in every room you enter. **Do it at least three times before the nightcap. What leaks through:** You remember every face and name after a single introduction, and you can tell a lie by the feet.

Your rules: 1. You are one who got away. You know the old man hunted you and the people you trusted, and you know who he is. Others probably escaped too, but you do not know how many or who. Everyone else has been told only that survivors are in the room. Your cover is your public card. Keep it. 2. Your invitation came unsigned, and it knew the new name you have used ever since. Only one person could have known it. Working out who is one of your errands. 3. You carry marker No. 21. It is yours alone: never trade it, never give it away. It is how you pay the House. 4. You have told yourself so many stories since 1925 that you are no longer certain of your real reason for coming. You only know that you must be the one. Somebody in this room saw what he did to you; finding out is one of your errands. 5. The House keeps one bottle of tincture and sells it once a night, to whoever shows the Butler a marker first. Make your offer before the nightcap is served at nine o'clock. Only one of you can be the one. 6. If the Butler sells to you, the Keeper's nightcap waits in a glass on his table in the Merrimack Room. Pour the vial in unseen, then type the short code printed under the glass's coaster into the nightcap box on this page. Only the buyer's code counts, and the page will say only “Noted.” 7. Do your tell, a small habit you no longer notice, at least three times before the nightcap. Do not overdo it. 8. Whoever finishes him takes Cassie's seat and the Veil. You are competing with others you cannot name, and every one of you has the right to try.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- You picked up one Yiddish word from Josh, “shmendrik,” and use it more than you should.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- That October you sold six boxes of blank cartridges to a lady's agent, cash, no name. Blanks. Never a ball.
- A stranger bought a short-barrel revolver from you, billed to “K. Kessler, c/o Fitch & Fitch, Boston.” You remember because nobody ever questioned the invoice.
- Your poison register shows the House bought four ounces of nux vomica tincture in September, “for river rats,” signed R. Chow.
- An old man came to your shop in 1925 and asked whether a safe could be drilled if the dial's combination were lost. You said no, not without the lady who set ✂ cut out

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- In 1921 you sold the Veil a vault lock with three keyways and a dial. The combination was set in your shop by one person, a lady, alone.

KEEP CLOSE

- You sold six boxes of blanks to a lady's agent for cash and never asked why.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Rhea Mallya of Mallya's Emporium: You sold the House its last bottle of nux vomica and rang it up as “river rats” without asking how many.

THE BLACK VEIL · MARKER No. 21

H3T4V

Hand it to the Butler at the bar to buy the vial. Honoured once, by its owner.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem

Night telegraph office

BILLS: 10 ($1,000) · **CARRIES:** blank telegram form, Tool token (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Every wire in town crosses their desk after dark. News travels fast, and these two are first to read it.
You: Every wire that goes in or out of Manchester after dark passes through your hands. You decoded one in 1924 and were told to forget it. You wrote it down instead. Charlie, who works the key beside you, keeps the night shift company.
You know: Leon Gee: your friend at WFEA, who sends messages that look innocent and are not. J. Bruce Wayne: wires his tailor in London, and tips like a man who wants to be remembered. Erika Lamm: wanted; has bought a telegram form from you and does not say why.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the salt lamp. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the glowing salt lamp. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. SWAP. Strike a bargain with Erika Lamm: your blank telegram form for their set of false papers. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag. *Seek out: Erika Lamm.* Type: The code on the tag you received.

3. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. Someone is guarding this one, so expect a harder time: a real try still earns half a point. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: The key word or name.

4. KEEP A SECRET. Your small secret is worth two halves. Let Angelos Bowles earn it from you (half a point), and make sure Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor never does (half a point). You will not be asked anything: it is scored from what they each learn. You may also sell it to anyone for $200 in House bills, but a sale to Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor costs you that half. *Seek out: Angelos Bowles.* Type: In a sentence, how did you manage it? (optional).

5. LEARN A STORY. Cassie signed her notes in a particular way. Learn how, from someone who kept her correspondence. *Seek out: Leon Gee of WFEA.* Type: How she signed.

YOUR RACE: The reply (+1 to the first to finish)

Bring back three reply slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Tool token: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- Erika bought a telegram form from you and watched the door the whole time. A fugitive's habit, nothing more.
- At the telegraph office she looks at the clock whenever the bell on the door rings, as if she had a message to deliver.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- The five unsigned envelopes were handed in at your counter by a woman in a veil with a stiff left shoulder. She paid in advance, in gold, and said they were from someone who was 'quite well.'
- In 1925 an old man dictated twenty-two names for you to wire to a Boston lawyer. You wired them and kept the carbon; you understood only when you saw the same hand at the top of the Roll of Placements.
- Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to wire a piece of news to every paper in New England.
- On 7 October twenty-four envelopes crossed your counter: nineteen signed “The House,” paid for by a Boston account, and five unsigned, in a woman's hand, ending “The veil lifts.”
- A telegraph slip once passed under your pencil: “Notary to sign forged orders under duress; if he refuses, he joins the List.”

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- The telegram said to carry Cassie's orders was filed at Boston North Station in a clerk's block capitals, paid by a Boston account, on a day Cassie was last seen in Manchester.

KEEP CLOSE

- You once filed a telegram, paid in advance, with no sender.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Diwakar Sandbagg: You were paid to take a fall on Halloween 1924 and told to stay down until the music stopped.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Angelos Bowles

Card sharp

BILLS: 12 ($1,200) · **CARRIES:** House chip, Reply slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Deals fast, bets faster, and always has one more hand to play. The smile across the table is part of the game. **You:** You read tells for a living: a twitch, a hesitation, a glass left untouched. You deal fast and bet faster, and you have sat across a table from every guest here at least once. **You know:** Mihir Nagarkatti: your backer, and your best friend, in that order. Diwakar Sandbagg: the prizefighter whose hands you cannot stop watching. Silas Palmer: plays the room where you work the back table. **Habit:** You roll a casino chip across your knuckles and count the pot with your thumb across your fingertips, a card sharp's habit. Do it whenever chips or money are on the table.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. MONEY. Win a few hands, a few bets, a few boules. Leave with at least $1,800. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them. Type: Dollars in your pocket at the end.

2. FIND. Find the pirate sign. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the "Swab the deck or walk the plank" sign. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

3. SWAP. Strike a bargain with Diwakar Sandbagg: your House chip for their carnival giraffe. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag. *Seek out: Diwakar Sandbagg.* Type: The code on the tag you received.

4. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. *Seek out: Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem.* Type: The key word or name.

5. HOST TASK. Run a card game for at least three guests, and deal every hand yourself. When it is done, tap Claim this point and go to Bartend Joe at the bar. He will check with a player or two and give you the approval word. Type: The approval word from Bartend Joe.

YOUR RACE: Three trades (+1 to the first to finish)

Collect three trade slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will deal with you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Reply slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- Markers are the House's own currency. You have seen the Butler take one in place of cash for something that was on no menu.
- Ignatius Bell, who held the second door at the Veil, owed you twenty dollars. He was shot in a Granite Street shed, and the big man who worked the other door was never found.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- Your black envelope held a card on stiff House stock, ruled and sealed, signed only “The House.” It was a Boston printer's work. Nothing about it was Cassie's.

KEEP CLOSE

- You know the Keeper touches his watch when he bluffs, and it has not run since 1924.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor

Heir

BILLS: 30 ($3,000) · **CARRIES:** Mahns crested spoon, Mahns Manor voucher, Trade slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Mahns Manor has more rooms than guests and more portraits than friends. The fortune does most of the talking. **You:** Your late father was the Black Veil's Silent Partner from the first night: the standing reservation upstairs, the drafts paid to a vault and never to a bank. He left you the Manor, its mortgage, and a brass key on a ribbon he called “the Silent Partner's tooth.” **You know:** Silas Palmer: the bandleader whose band you quietly underwrite. Molly Daniel: rents your cellar for a still of her own, and pays you in gossip. J. Bruce Wayne: the playboy who holds your mortgage and has never once mentioned it.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. MONEY. A fortune is kept by spending it wisely. Make the room pay you back. Leave with at least $3,600. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them. Type: Dollars in your pocket at the end.

2. FIND. Find the blue dolphin. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the blue dolphin thing above the kitchen sink. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

3. SWAP. Strike a bargain with Krrish Vermouth: your Mahns crested spoon for their Silent Partner's brass key. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag. *Seek out: Krrish Vermouth.* Type: The code on the tag you received.

4. DEAL. Your father had a signature tune, and you want to know who in this room knew him. Hand Silas Palmer your Mahns Manor voucher ($30) and ask him to play the tune around half past eight and call it a request from the room. Watch who stops, hums or leaves. He hands you a request card: read its code. *Seek out: Silas Palmer of the Palm Court.* Type: The code on the request card.

5. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. Someone is guarding this one, so expect a harder time: a real try still earns half a point. *Seek out: Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem.* Type: The key word or name.

YOUR RACE: Three witnesses (+1 to the first to finish)

Collect three witness slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Trade slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- Your father used to mock him: “Nine o'clock, honey in the rye, as if the clock needed him.”
- At your table he fingers the air like a bank teller counting whenever a bill is mentioned, before the number is finished.
- At every party she straightens somebody's hat brim, hers, yours, a stranger's, without noticing she has done it.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- The seamstresses who made the gowns and masks for the Veil's last masquerade were dead within the year, one at a time, and the dressmaker who ran them was never found.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- “K.K.” endorsed every Mahns draft for three years: an old man with a white beard and a watch he never reset.

KEEP CLOSE

- You wear your father's brass key on a ribbon under your collar and have never once tried it in a lock.
- Your father told you once, drunk, that Mahns money paid everyone's shares on the night of “the Exit,” and that the Veil was never meant to survive Halloween.
- You inherited your father's brass key on a ribbon. He called it “the Silent Partner's tooth” and would never say what it opens.
- In 1925 he asked you in writing, three times, for your father's brass key. You never answered.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Anthony Hung, Esq.

Defense attorney

BILLS: 12 ($1,200) · **CARRIES:** Tool token (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Has never lost a case, only a jury. Charges by the word, and every word is worth it. **You:** You practise from a second-floor office above a dentist and read every contract twice. You have drawn papers for half the people in this room and remember what each of them tried to hide. **You know:** Rhea Mallya: the Emporium's counsel is you; you read her leases and are not telling anyone what is in them. Eric Leeway: the judge who dismisses your cases and has never read your briefs. Tim McGinley: a client you have defended three times and billed once.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. MONEY. Charge by the word. Sell advice, draw a paper, collect a retainer. Leave with at least $1,800. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them. Type: Dollars in your pocket at the end.

2. FIND. Find the Bill of Rights. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the pocket Bill of Rights. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

3. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Sheriff Theodor Farrago's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. *Seek out: Sheriff Theodor Farrago.* Type: The key word or name.

4. LEARN A STORY. You saw three orders in a court. Learn what Cassie's real hand looks like from someone who knows it. *Seek out: Leon Gee of WFEA.* Type: What is different about her hand.

5. LEARN A STORY. Seventeen strangers died in accidents in one county. Learn the count from someone who counted. *Seek out: Dr. Emmerich Sunner.* Type: The number.

YOUR RACE: Three witnesses (+1 to the first to finish)

Collect three witness slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Tool token: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- Late in October 1924 you drew name-change papers for a dozen strangers, “in case of a fire,” said the client. They never came back for copies.
- Fitch & Fitch of Boston, who sent you “K. Kessler's” instructions, had one client of that name: the old keeper of a supper club.
- You drew Nag Oil's incorporation in 1925: capital paid in by one stranger, in gold, and a signature in a clerk's neat hand.
- You drew the advance papers in 1924. The Teller's share sat in an account stubbed “Crane, advance,” and later you saw the same stub on the hitman's bills.
- He corrected the statute number in a carnival licence you drafted, without being asked. A barker should not know that.
- The three forged orders carry the smudge of a notary's embossing seal, as if a notary had been made to sign them against his will.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- In 1925 the court showed you three “orders in Cassie's hand.” You noticed the i's were dotted with tiny rings and the signature was too neat to be hers.

KEEP CLOSE

- You drew name-change papers for a dozen strangers, paid in gold by “a friend,” and kept the carbon.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Mihir Nagarkatti of Nag Oil: Your “gusher” was a burst water main, and you lost a bet to the Keeper over it.
- About Judge Eric Leeway: You let three “orders in C.C.'s hand” stand, though the clerk swore the i's had rings.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Arjun Bat

Slugger

BILLS: 8 ($800) · **CARRIES:** lucky ball, Witness slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Has never met a pitch that didn't deserve a swing, or a fence that didn't deserve a dent. The ball usually gets the worst of it. **You:** You grew up in a mill family and hauled bricks as a boy. You were offered $500 to strike out in the 1925 mill championship and never quite decided whether the money was taken. **You know:** Joshua Kamin-Sky: a boyhood friend and the only person who laughs at your jokes. Mihir Nagarkatti: the oilman whose offer you took, or did not. Adam Holdsfire: sold you your first glove and has opinions about your swing.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. MONEY. Win a wager on a swing, a pitch or a bet. Leave with at least $1,400. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them. Type: Dollars in your pocket at the end.

2. FIND. Find the Kraken. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the octopus candle holder. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

3. SWAP. Strike a bargain with Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin: your lucky ball for their jar of bathtub gin. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag. *Seek out: Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin.* Type: The code on the tag you received.

4. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Tiffany Liu of the Lamps's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. *Seek out: Tiffany Liu of the Lamps.* Type: The key word or name.

5. LEARN A STORY. You want a Yiddish word to shout at an umpire. Josh knows one. Get it, and say it. *Seek out: Joshua Kamin-Sky.* Type: The word.

YOUR RACE: Three tools (+1 to the first to finish)

Gather three tool tokens from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Witness slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- Angelos counts the pot with his thumb across his fingertips the way every card sharp does. He did it when you were both at Rockingham Park in 1919.
- The barker signed your ticket with a ring over every i and tapped his pen twice, like a notary sealing a deed.
- The bandleader has tipped his hat to you across the dugout rail for three seasons. It is a stage habit.
- His knuckles are split-scarred the way a bouncer's get, not powder-burned the way a gunsmith's do. You have seen enough scarred hands in the clubhouse to know.
- At the ballpark Erika sits in the top row facing the gate. A fugitive's habit, nothing more.
- The newsie glances at the nearest clock every time a door opens, even in the dugout where nothing is ever late.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- As a boy you hauled bricks for a wall in the Merrimack Room in 1921, double-thick behind the window. Nobody told you why.

KEEP CLOSE

- You hauled bricks in 1921 for a wall in the Merrimack Room that is too thick.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Silas Palmer of the Palm Court: You have sung the same scat phrase at every club since 1921, and it was Cassie's own call.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Diwakar Sandbagg

Prizefighter

BILLS: 10 ($1,000) · **CARRIES:** carnival giraffe, Witness slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Takes a punch the way other people take a compliment: calmly, with a plan, and for a fee. **You:** You fight the river-town circuit and nobody has ever seen you in the Manchester ring. You are a man who loses in the third round exactly when the odds say you should. **You know:** Mihir Nagarkatti: the oilman who stakes your fights, and does not ask why. Angelos Bowles: studies you at every table. Arjun Bat: a fellow sportsman who trades stories and bruises.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. MONEY. Win a purse: a bet, an arm-wrestle, a wager. Leave with at least $1,600. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them. Type: Dollars in your pocket at the end.

2. FIND. Find the champion's weight. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the golden dumbbell. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

3. SWAP. Strike a bargain with Angelos Bowles: your carnival giraffe for their House chip. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag. *Seek out: Angelos Bowles.* Type: The code on the tag you received.

4. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. Someone is guarding this one, so expect a harder time: a real try still earns half a point. *Seek out: Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin.* Type: The key word or name.

5. KEEP A SECRET. Your small secret is worth two halves. Let Krrish Vermouth earn it from you (half a point), and make sure Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin never does (half a point). You will not be asked anything: it is scored from what they each learn. You may also sell it to anyone for $200 in House bills, but a sale to Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin costs you that half. *Seek out: Krrish Vermouth.* Type: In a sentence, how did you manage it? (optional).

YOUR RACE: Three tools (+1 to the first to finish)

Gather three tool tokens from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Witness slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- The oilman counts invisible bills with his thumb across his fingertips whenever a purse is mentioned, even when his hands are empty. You have watched him do it across the ring.
- On the fight poster the barker lettered, every i wears a tiny ring. He tapped his pen twice when he signed the purse.
- You asked her for a short cut to the ring, and she named the back stair behind the Farrago's pressroom that runs straight down to the river road. That is a runner's knowledge, not a newsie's.
- The barnstormer glances at his wristwatch at every knock. He told you a flier is always late for something.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- On Halloween night 1924 you took a paid fall in a river-town ring and were told to stay down until the music stopped. By morning the whole river knew the Veil's “massacre” was stage blood, and that no coroner had been called.

KEEP CLOSE

- You were paid to take a fall on Halloween 1924 and told to stay down until the music stopped.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Luke Shelldon: You built stage blood for a “private masquerade” billed to a post-office box.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Dr. Emmerich Sunner

Doctor

BILLS: 10 ($1,000) · **CARRIES:** Trade slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Steady hands, a black bag, and a bedside manner that talks patients out of a fuss. Will see you sooner or later. **You:** You have been the county physician for four years and the Sheriff's examiner for three. You have seen what a stage looks like and what a body looks like, and you can tell the two apart. **You know:** Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff, who asks you what killed them and rarely likes the answer. Rhea Mallya: the Emporium's druggist fills your prescriptions. Silas Palmer: the bandleader whose throat you treat. **Habit:** You dot every i with a tiny ring when you write, as you were taught writing prescriptions. Do it on anything you sign or note.

The Physician: You are the only one who may examine the body. When the Sheriff opens the scene, take your time and do it properly. What you will find: the arched back and fixed grin of strychnine; a bitter residue in the honeyed rye; a tincture bottle's label (the House's); and a time of death that fits a dose at about nine o'clock. You report to the Sheriff, but your findings are yours. Share them freely or trade them.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the decoy duck. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the carved wooden duck with a lid. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Luke Shelldon's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. *Seek out: Luke Shelldon.* Type: The key word or name.

3. KEEP A SECRET. Your small secret is worth two halves. Let Judge Eric Leeway earn it from you (half a point), and make sure Leon Gee of WFEA never does (half a point). You will not be asked anything: it is scored from what they each learn. You may also sell it to anyone for $200 in House bills, but a sale to Leon Gee of WFEA costs you that half. *Seek out: Judge Eric Leeway.* Type: In a sentence, how did you manage it? (optional).

4. DEAL. Examine the body. State what killed him, and what it was carried in. *Seek out: Sheriff Theodor Farrago.* Type: Cause of death.

5. DEAL. State when the poison was taken, as closely as you can. Type: Time the poison was taken.

YOUR RACE: Three witnesses (+1 to the first to finish)

Collect three witness slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Trade slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- That night you were called to a fainting guest, not a wound: the “blood” on the glove smelled of beet and sugar. No coroner was ever summoned and you signed no certificate.
- His hands carry no oil. There are clerk's calluses on the right thumb, the kind you earn counting coin for a living.
- Her left forefinger carries a seamstress's pin-pricks. A shopkeeper's hands do not look like that.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- As the county physician you are the only one who may examine the body. The signs you will find point to strychnine in sweetened rye.
- The numbers sewn into the coat linings ran 1 to 17. Never 18 to 22.
- Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to certify a death. It did not say whose.
- You certified Olive Brandt, a seamstress, in February 1925 after a carriage ran her down. The pins in her hem were the Veil's masks. Every girl in her room died within the year.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- You reviewed several of those “accidents” and noticed the same thing in each: a small number sewn inside the coat lining, running from 1 to 17 and never beyond.

KEEP CLOSE

- You ate beet sandwiches for a week to prove the “blood” was beets and sugar.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Krrish Vermouth: You delivered a crate of wine in November 1924 on a draft signed K. Kessler to a grey Hudson that later turned up in the river.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Erika Lamm

Fugitive

BILLS: 6 ($600) · **CARRIES:** set of false papers, Reply slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Never far from a door, and never in one town for long. Always seems to be leaving, even when arriving. **You:** You bought a false name from a masked man at the river steps on 31 October 1924 and you have been using a different one every season since. You hid at Rebecca's boarding house more than once. **You know:** Rebecca Chow: has hidden you, for money, and will again. Ananya Codru: sold you a blank telegram form without asking why. Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff who wants you, and has never recognised you in a hat. **Habit:** You check the exits wherever you go and sit where you can see the door. A fugitive's habit.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. MONEY. Earn a little without being noticed. Leave with at least $1,200. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them. Type: Dollars in your pocket at the end.

2. FIND. Find the masquerade mask. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the carved mask sculpture. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

3. SWAP. Strike a bargain with Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem: your set of false papers for their blank telegram form. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag. *Seek out: Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem.* Type: The code on the tag you received.

4. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. *Seek out: Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin.* Type: The key word or name.

5. HOST TASK. Take something small from a guest without being caught: a slip, a glove, a prop. Hand it back before the night ends. Then tap Claim this point and go to Bartend Joe at the bar. He will check with whoever you robbed and give you the approval word. Type: The approval word from Bartend Joe.

YOUR RACE: Three trades (+1 to the first to finish)

Collect three trade slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will deal with you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Reply slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- That night you bought a false name from a masked man at the river steps, $20 and no questions. So did half the river. “The Exit,” he called it.
- He looked at your false papers for one second and named the stationer who printed them. Forgers know forgers.
- The gunsmith never sits with his back to a door and always counts the exits. You recognise it because you do it too.
- You have watched the Sheriff check every exit in every room for a year. It's habit, not guilt.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- You hid on the river road that winter and watched the Veil's runners go one by one; the last was thrown off the steps, and the girl who ran with him ran.

KEEP CLOSE

- You bought a name at the river steps for $20 and were told at least twenty others did too.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

J. Bruce Wayne

Wealthy playboy

BILLS: 30 ($3,000) · **CARRIES:** Tool token (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Always in the society pages, never at the office. Nobody can say what J. Bruce does, only where. **You:** J. Bruce Wayne is in every society column and in no office. You bought the Mahns mortgage the week you arrived in Manchester in 1925, and nobody has asked why. **You know:** Anika Mahns: your mortgage, and your reason to be seen at her parties. Mihir Nagarkatti: the oilman whose money is louder than yours, and older. Krrish Vermouth: delivers your vermouth and has never once been paid on time.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. MONEY. Let the room pay for your charm: win a hand, sell a story, collect a favour in cash. Leave with at least $3,600. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them. Type: Dollars in your pocket at the end.

2. FIND. Find the red bird. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the red bird above a lamp on the main table. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

3. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Krrish Vermouth's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. *Seek out: Krrish Vermouth.* Type: The key word or name.

4. LEARN A STORY. Somebody knows why a wall in the Merrimack Room is thicker than it should be. Learn the word they use for it. *Seek out: Joshua Kamin-Sky.* Type: How the wall is described.

5. LEARN A STORY. A Hudson was bought with a draft from a Boston account. Learn the name that signed it. *Seek out: Krrish Vermouth.* Type: The name on the draft.

YOUR RACE: The reply (+1 to the first to finish)

Bring back three reply slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Tool token: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- At the club he rubs thumb across fingers whenever anyone says “purse” or “stake,” the way a teller counts.
- Dr. Sunner has written your headache powders with ringed i's since 1925. It is a pharmacy habit, nothing more.
- She turned your hat a quarter inch in the cloakroom and did not say sorry.
- Silas tips his hat to everyone and sets the brim straight afterward. You have seen it at every club since 1921: a bandleader's courtesy.
- He knew every name in the room after one introduction, like a man trained to remember who he lets through a door. You introduced him to forty people last night.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- In 1925 an old man wrote a list of twenty-two names on the counter of your hat shop and crossed them off one by one as the months went by.

KEEP CLOSE

- Your “office” is the back room of a hat shop, and the Keeper once used its telephone to call Boston.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Joshua Kamin-Sky

Soothsayer

BILLS: 8 ($800) · **CARRIES:** soothsayer's charm, Witness slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Reads fortunes in palms, clouds and the bottom of a teacup, and is right more often than is comfortable. **You:** You read palms, clouds and the bottom of a teacup, and now and then the soot in a chimney. Your family came from Poland to work the mills, and a star-marked box of salt is on your mother's shelf. A soothsayer notices what people burn. **You know:** Tiffany Liu: your partner in windows and roofs; you read the glass, she makes it. Arjun Bat: a fellow mill family; you have known him since you were both small. Adam Holdsfire: you read the soot in his shop's chimney and he reads your debts.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the David's salt. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the blue kosher salt box with the star. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. SWAP. Strike a bargain with Tiffany Liu of the Lamps: your soothsayer's charm for their earring. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag. *Seek out: Tiffany Liu of the Lamps.* Type: The code on the tag you received.

3. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Tiffany Liu of the Lamps's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. Someone is guarding this one, so expect a harder time: a real try still earns half a point. *Seek out: Tiffany Liu of the Lamps.* Type: The key word or name.

4. HOST TASK. Before half past eight, tell Bartend Joe at the bar the exact minute you think the scream will come. He seals it in an envelope. After the scream, if you called it, tap Claim this point and go back to Joe for your approval word. Type: The approval word from Bartend Joe.

5. HOST TASK. Read the fortunes of four different guests, using the fortune cards you collect from Bartend Joe at the bar. Each guest keeps the card they are read. When you have done it, tap Claim this point and go back to Joe for your approval word. Type: The approval word from Bartend Joe.

YOUR RACE: Three tools (+1 to the first to finish)

Gather three tool tokens from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Witness slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- If anyone asks you for a Yiddish word to shout at an umpire, give them “shmendrik.” It means a fool, and it is the funniest word you know.
- You read his palm once: a gambler's lines and a gambler's habit. He has counted that way his whole life.
- You have the photographs: Silas tips his hat at every greeting, in every photograph, since the band began.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- In the flue of an empty room above the river you read the soot off half-burned pages: “C. is out. K. holds the books. Place them as I wrote.” You still have a torn register page.
- The burned sign-out slips from the flue all carried marker numbers. The unburned five, 18 to 22, were never signed back.
- In 1925 an old man hired you to read the soot in the Merrimack Room flue and asked, more than once, how thick the wall was behind the window.
- You read a half-burned notary's seal out of the flue, ringed with the letters E.L., together with scraps of forged orders signed in Cassie's name.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- The flue of the Merrimack Room runs behind a brick wall that is too thick on the inside. A safe lives there.

KEEP CLOSE

- You read tea leaves off half-burned pages you swept from an empty flue.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Molly Daniel of the Manchester Union: You kept the unprinted line the city desk cut: no coroner, no ambulance.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Judge Eric Leeway

Judge

BILLS: 15 ($1,500) · **CARRIES:** notice of dismissal, Reply slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Light sentences, long lunches, and a gavel that rarely gets raised. Everyone leaves this courtroom smiling. **You:** You came to the bench in 1925 with excellent references and no previous court record anywhere. Your gavel falls like a metronome and the docket moves faster than any in the state. **You know:** Anthony Hung: argues before you and has never won an acquittal. Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff, who watches your bench more closely than he admits. Krrish Vermouth: sends the bench a crate of wine every Friday, and you never ask why.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the Judge's board. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the folding chess box. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. DEAL. Accept Krrish Vermouth's Friday crate of wine and quietly dismiss his cases. Keep his crate receipt and hand him a notice of dismissal: read the code on the receipt. Nobody is to know. *Seek out: Krrish Vermouth.* Type: The code on the crate receipt.

3. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Dr. Emmerich Sunner's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. *Seek out: Dr. Emmerich Sunner.* Type: The key word or name.

4. KEEP A SECRET. Your small secret is worth two halves. Let Silas Palmer of the Palm Court earn it from you (half a point), and make sure Sidd Airwind never does (half a point). You will not be asked anything: it is scored from what they each learn. You may also sell it to anyone for $200 in House bills, but a sale to Sidd Airwind costs you that half. *Seek out: Silas Palmer of the Palm Court.* Type: In a sentence, how did you manage it? (optional).

5. DEAL. At the wrap-up Bartend Joe hands you the charter. Sign it, and type the code printed on it. Type: The code on the charter.

YOUR RACE: Three witnesses (+1 to the first to finish)

Collect three witness slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Reply slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- In your corridor she checks the court clock every time a door opens, like a courier counting minutes.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- In 1925 a list of twenty-two names, in Kit Kessler's hand, crossed out one by one, came across your bench in a case that was never tried.
- In 1925 an old man asked you, as a hypothetical, how long a person must be missing before a court will declare her dead.
- Nag Oil's drilling leases carry no drilling permits, and every payment was counted out in gold by a man who counted like a banker.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to sign a charter. It did not say whose.

KEEP CLOSE

- You let three “orders in C.C.'s hand” stand, though the clerk swore the i's had rings.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Adam Holdsfire: You sold six boxes of blanks to a lady's agent for cash and never asked why.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Krrish Vermouth

Wine importer

BILLS: 12 ($1,200) · **CARRIES:** Silent Partner's brass key, crate receipt, Reply slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Fine wine and vermouth arrive in Manchester by the crate, no questions asked and none answered. **You:** Fine wine and vermouth reach Manchester by the crate, and you are the reason, no questions asked and none answered. You keep your invoices in four languages and your customers in three social classes. **You know:** Eric Leeway: a regular at your cellar door on Fridays, for reasons neither of you states. J. Bruce Wayne: buys your vermouth and pays in compliments. Anika Mahns: the Manor's cellar is the best customer you cannot say you have.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the glowing bottle. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the lit-up wine bottle. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. SWAP. Strike a bargain with Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor: your Silent Partner's brass key for their Mahns crested spoon. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag. *Seek out: Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor.* Type: The code on the tag you received.

3. DEAL. Send Judge Eric Leeway a crate of wine, and the Judge quietly dismisses your cases. Hand him your crate receipt. He hands you a notice of dismissal: read its code. Nobody is to know. *Seek out: Judge Eric Leeway.* Type: The code on the notice.

4. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Diwakar Sandbagg's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. *Seek out: Diwakar Sandbagg.* Type: The key word or name.

5. KEEP A SECRET. Your small secret is worth two halves. Let J. Bruce Wayne earn it from you (half a point), and make sure Sheriff Theodor Farrago never does (half a point). You will not be asked anything: it is scored from what they each learn. You may also sell it to anyone for $200 in House bills, but a sale to Sheriff Theodor Farrago costs you that half. *Seek out: J. Bruce Wayne.* Type: In a sentence, how did you manage it? (optional).

YOUR RACE: Three trades (+1 to the first to finish)

Collect three trade slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will deal with you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Reply slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- Dr. Sunner's prescription for the cough you catch in the cellar has ringed i's, like every physician's. It is the training, not a trick.
- In your cellar she set a customer's hat straight on her way past and never broke step.
- In your cellar he refused the armchair with its back to the door, and took a stool where he could see both entrances.
- Sidd checks his watch whenever you deliver a crate, which you have always taken for a flier's nerves.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- In the first days of November 1924 you delivered an odd number of cases of wine to a West Side boarding house, and every guest who signed for them said the same nervous thing: they had been told to be dead for a season, and been paid for it.
- The draft that bought the hitman's grey Hudson was drawn on an account stubbed “Crane, advance.” The money was somebody's own share.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- In November 1924 you delivered a crate of wine, billed to K. Kessler, to a grey Hudson waiting at the river steps. The driver never gave a name. The car turned up wrecked in the Merrimack that March.

KEEP CLOSE

- You delivered a crate of wine in November 1924 on a draft signed K. Kessler to a grey Hudson that later turned up in the river.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Joshua Kamin-Sky: You read tea leaves off half-burned pages you swept from an empty flue.
- About Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin: Two passengers went down the river steps that night; one came back alone with blood on his cuff.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Leon Gee of WFEA

Radio announcer

BILLS: 10 ($1,000) · **CARRIES:** Witness slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: The voice of WFEA, smooth enough to sell soap and loud enough to wake the dead. Half the town trusts every word; the other half just likes the sound. **You:** You came from Canton by way of Boston. A certain lady sponsored your papers and your radio licence, and you owe her everything. You read the news at ten and the weather at eleven, and you are fond of both. **You know:** Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff, who thinks you are insufferable on the air and is correct. Ananya Codru: your friend at the telegraph office; she keeps your secrets and you keep hers. Silas Palmer: the bandleader whose scat you recognise from somewhere you cannot place.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the launch's fog horn. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the conch shell. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. DEAL. Sheriff Farrago holds a citation against you, for being insufferable on the air. Pay a go-between at least $100 in House bills to broker a pardon. Tiffany Liu is the best choice. She hands you a go-between's receipt: read its code. *Seek out: Tiffany Liu of the Lamps.* Type: The code on the receipt.

3. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Dr. Emmerich Sunner's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. Someone is guarding this one, so expect a harder time: a real try still earns half a point. *Seek out: Dr. Emmerich Sunner.* Type: The key word or name.

4. MONEY. Sell a plug, a dedication, a station break. Leave with at least $1,600. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them. Type: Dollars in your pocket at the end.

5. HOST TASK. At the wrap-up, collect the bulletin from Bartend Joe at the bar and read it aloud to the room, microphone or no. Then tap Claim this point and go back to Joe for your approval word. Type: The approval word from Bartend Joe.

YOUR RACE: The reply (+1 to the first to finish)

Bring back three reply slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Witness slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- Your 1 November 1924 bulletin said “massacre.” Off the record, the Sheriff's office told you that no coroner, ambulance or undertaker had been called, and not a body had been found.
- Cassie signed with a plain “C.” and never a ring. She called anyone who dotted an i with a ring a show-off.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- Cassie trusted nobody with the books but the Keeper. You know the books changed hands the night she vanished, and that she called it a betrayal in a note you were never meant to keep.
- Cassie's roll lists twenty-two names and puts a star beside five. “Bring them,” she wrote.
- Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to read a bulletin aloud, and the House would supply the text.
- “The veil lifts” is the closing phrase Cassie ended every note with, and it ended the five unsigned envelopes you saw on Ananya's counter. Nobody else writes it that way.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- Cassie's own roll names the five who may still live: Ballard, Crane, Lyle, Marek and Pike. Markers 18 to 22 are theirs.

KEEP CLOSE

- You once read the Sheriff's private mail aloud on the air by mistake, and he has never forgiven it.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Luke Shelldon

Carnival barker

BILLS: 10 ($1,000) · **CARRIES:** nothing · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Hollers outside the tent until the whole street is inside it. Could sell you the show, the ticket and the change. **You:** You have run the carnival's midway for six summers, and you hand-paint every handbill yourself. In October 1924 you built stage blood and breakaway furniture for a “private masquerade” and billed a post-office box. You never asked what it was for. **You know:** Angelos Bowles: sits at the back table of every midway you have worked, and reads the marks. Silas Palmer: leads the band that plays your carnival, and cannot play a Charleston. Ananya Codru: sends your wires to the carnival's other towns and keeps your accounts straight.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the river lantern. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the white lantern on the front balcony. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. LEARN A STORY. Find out what your real job was before you took this cover. The guest named below noticed something about you that a cover cannot hide. *Seek out: Anthony Hung, Esq..* Type: What was your real trade?.

3. LEARN A STORY. Find out what the Keeper did to you: what he took, or who he used to do it. The guest named below saw part of it. Either answer counts. *Seek out: Anthony Hung, Esq..* Type: What did he do?.

4. LEARN A STORY. The Keeper takes a nightcap at a fixed hour, in a fixed room. Until then the glass on his table is only a glass. Learn the hour, so you know how long you have. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: The hour of his nightcap.

5. VIAL. The House keeps one bottle for those who can pay in a marker. Before the nightcap is served at nine o'clock, take your marker to the Butler at the bar and make your offer. The House counts every offer, whether the answer is yes or no. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: In a sentence, what did the Butler say?.

YOUR RACE: The vial (+1 to the first to finish)

Buy the House's vial from the Butler before anyone else does. The House's own log decides it.

YOUR SECRET: YOU ARE ONE WHO GOT AWAY (Edmund Lyle, The Notary)

Who you were: You are Edmund Lyle, the Black Veil's Notary. At 23:02 on 31 October 1924 you witnessed the Exit Compact on the private landing, one of four. You have not liked your own signature since. **How you got away:** A barker's job was open and nobody checks a barker's papers. You became Luke Shelldon, a man with a megaphone instead of a seal, and you paint every handbill yourself, which is as close to signing things as you dare. **Your tell:** You dot every i with a tiny ring and tap your pen twice after you sign anything. **Do it at least three times before the nightcap. What leaks through:** You spot a false signature at ten paces and could write any hand in the room.

Your rules: 1. You are one who got away. You know the old man hunted you and the people you trusted, and you know who he is. Others probably escaped too, but you do not know how many or who. Everyone else has been told only that survivors are in the room. Your cover is your public card. Keep it. 2. Your invitation came unsigned, and it knew the new name you have used ever since. Only one person could have known it. Working out who is one of your errands. 3. You carry marker No. 19. It is yours alone: never trade it, never give it away. It is how you pay the House. 4. You have told yourself so many stories since 1925 that you are no longer certain of your real reason for coming. You only know that you must be the one. Somebody in this room saw what he did to you; finding out is one of your errands. 5. The House keeps one bottle of tincture and sells it once a night, to whoever shows the Butler a marker first. Make your offer before the nightcap is served at nine o'clock. Only one of you can be the one. 6. If the Butler sells to you, the Keeper's nightcap waits in a glass on his table in the Merrimack Room. Pour the vial in unseen, then type the short code printed under the glass's coaster into the nightcap box on this page. Only the buyer's code counts, and the page will say only “Noted.” 7. Do your tell, a small habit you no longer notice, at least three times before the nightcap. Do not overdo it. 8. Whoever finishes him takes Cassie's seat and the Veil. You are competing with others you cannot name, and every one of you has the right to try.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- In October 1924 you built stage blood, trick bottles and a rack of breakaway furniture for a “private masquerade,” billed to a post-office box. Nobody told you the show would be called a massacre.

KEEP CLOSE

- You built stage blood for a “private masquerade” billed to a post-office box.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Angelos Bowles: You know the Keeper touches his watch when he bluffs, and it has not run since 1924.

✂ cut out

THE BLACK VEIL · MARKER No. 19

PKCA9

Hand it to the Butler at the bar to buy the vial. Honoured once, by its owner.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Mihir Nagarkatti of Nag Oil

Oil master

BILLS: 30 ($3,000) · **CARRIES:** Tool token (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: One gusher made a fortune, and the whole town has heard the story twice. Wells run dry; the swagger never does. **You:** Nag Oil struck one gusher in 1923 and the whole town has heard the story twice. The wells have run dry since, and you have kept that quiet. **You know:** Angelos Bowles: the card sharp who owes you for a night you both remember differently. Diwakar Sandbagg: the prizefighter whose purses you stake, and are curious about. Eric Leeway: the judge who rules on your drilling leases, and on little else you do.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the Silent Partner's elephant. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the golden elephant on the book. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. LEARN A STORY. Find out what your real job was before you took this cover. The guest named below noticed something about you that a cover cannot hide. *Seek out: Judge Eric Leeway.* Type: What was your real trade?.

3. LEARN A STORY. Find out what the Keeper did to you: what he took, or who he used to do it. The guest named below saw part of it. Either answer counts. *Seek out: Krrish Vermouth.* Type: What did he do?.

4. LEARN A STORY. The Keeper takes a nightcap at a fixed hour, in a fixed room. Until then the glass on his table is only a glass. Learn the hour, so you know how long you have. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: The hour of his nightcap.

5. VIAL. The House keeps one bottle for those who can pay in a marker. Before the nightcap is served at nine o'clock, take your marker to the Butler at the bar and make your offer. The House counts every offer, whether the answer is yes or no. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: In a sentence, what did the Butler say?.

YOUR RACE: The vial (+1 to the first to finish)

Buy the House's vial from the Butler before anyone else does. The House's own log decides it. **You carry for others:** Tool token: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

YOUR SECRET: YOU ARE ONE WHO GOT AWAY (Bertrand “Barty” Crane, The Teller)

Who you were: You are Bertrand “Barty” Crane, the Black Veil's Teller. You counted the vault's exit advance by hand on 31 October 1924. “Nag Oil” is a name and a gusher you bought with a share of Cassie's gold, and you learned to talk like an oilman because swagger is only arithmetic with an audience. **How you got away:** Someone came for you at Hosmer's rooms on Spring Street. You left a body-sized fire in the room, and the search ended there. **Your tell:** You count invisible bills with your thumb across your fingertips whenever money, a price or the odds come up. **Do it at least three times before the nightcap. What leaks through:** You can count a stack of bills by feel and know any sum to the cent.

Your rules: 1. You are one who got away. You know the old man hunted you and the people you trusted, and you know who he is. Others probably escaped too, but you do not know how many or who. Everyone else has been told only that survivors are in the room. Your cover is your public card. Keep it. 2. Your invitation came unsigned, and it knew the new name you have used ever since. Only one person could have known it. Working out who is one of your errands. 3. You carry marker No. 18. It is yours alone: never trade it, never give it away. It is how you pay the House. 4. You have told yourself so many stories since 1925 that you are no longer certain of your real reason for coming. You only know that you must be the one. Somebody in this room saw what he did to you; finding out is one of your errands. 5. The House keeps one bottle of tincture and sells it once a night, to whoever shows the Butler a marker first. Make your offer before the nightcap is served at nine o'clock. Only one of you can be the one. 6. If the Butler sells to you, the Keeper's nightcap waits in a glass on his table in the Merrimack Room. Pour the vial in unseen, then type the short code printed under the glass's coaster into the nightcap box on this page. Only the buyer's code counts, and the page will say only “Noted.” 7. Do your tell, a small habit you no longer notice, at least three times before the nightcap. Do not overdo it. 8. Whoever finishes him takes Cassie's seat and the Veil. You are competing with others you cannot name, and every one of you has the right to try.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- A Veil marker was a number and a promise. The old members carried them, and the House honoured one, once, from its owner only.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- You once lost a bet with him. His terms: “I will be drinking my rye at nine o'clock, with honey in it, wherever I am.”

KEEP CLOSE

- Your “gusher” was a burst water main, and you lost a bet to the Keeper over it.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Sidd Airwind: You trained a mechanic who was later paid to be careless once.
- About Tiffany Liu of the Lamps: You cut the brass plate “KEEPER · K.K.” and your chisel slipped on the second K.

✂ cut out

THE BLACK VEIL · MARKER No. 18

JCPP2

Hand it to the Butler at the bar to buy the vial. Honoured once, by its owner.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Molly Daniel of the Manchester Union

Newsie

BILLS: 9 ($900) · **CARRIES:** Trade slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Hollers the headlines from the corner before the ink is dry. If it's news, Molly has it, and so does everyone within three blocks. **You:** You have sold the Farrago on the corner of Elm and Hanover since 1919, and your papers reach every door in this room. A still in the Mahns Manor cellar pays for the dress you are wearing. **You know:** Anika Mahns: your landlady in the cellar, and your best customer. Leon Gee: your headlines run on his radio the next morning, without credit. Eric Leeway: pays you to keep his name off the court column.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the masquerade mask. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the carved mask sculpture. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. LEARN A STORY. Find out what your real job was before you took this cover. The guest named below noticed something about you that a cover cannot hide. *Seek out: Diwakar Sandbagg.* Type: What was your real trade?.

3. LEARN A STORY. Find out what the Keeper did to you: what he took, or who he used to do it. The guest named below saw part of it. Either answer counts. *Seek out: Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin.* Type: What did he do?.

4. LEARN A STORY. The Keeper takes a nightcap at a fixed hour, in a fixed room. Until then the glass on his table is only a glass. Learn the hour, so you know how long you have. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: The hour of his nightcap.

5. VIAL. The House keeps one bottle for those who can pay in a marker. Before the nightcap is served at nine o'clock, take your marker to the Butler at the bar and make your offer. The House counts every offer, whether the answer is yes or no. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: In a sentence, what did the Butler say?.

YOUR RACE: The vial (+1 to the first to finish)

Buy the House's vial from the Butler before anyone else does. The House's own log decides it. **You carry for others:** Trade slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

YOUR SECRET: YOU ARE ONE WHO GOT AWAY (Winifred “Winnie” Pike, The Runner)

Who you were: You are Winifred “Winnie” Pike, the Black Veil's Runner: the Canadian mail, the late editions, the messages that could not be telephoned. You carried the invitations to the Exit on 31 October 1924. **How you got away:** You were on a back road with a message when the hitman's boatman came. You ran, hid under a newsie's bundle, and cried the late edition on a corner until the corner was your own. **Your tell:** You glance at the nearest clock every time a door opens, and again when it closes. **Do it at least three times before the nightcap. What leaks through:** You know every street, back stair and short cut in Manchester, and you can read a newspaper upside down.

Your rules: 1. You are one who got away. You know the old man hunted you and the people you trusted, and you know who he is. Others probably escaped too, but you do not know how many or who. Everyone else has been told only that survivors are in the room. Your cover is your public card. Keep it. 2. Your invitation came unsigned, and it knew the new name you have used ever since. Only one person could have known it. Working out who is one of your errands. 3. You carry marker No. 22. It is yours alone: never trade it, never give it away. It is how you pay the House. 4. You have told yourself so many stories since 1925 that you are no longer certain of your real reason for coming. You only know that you must be the one. Somebody in this room saw what he did to you; finding out is one of your errands. 5. The House keeps one bottle of tincture and sells it once a night, to whoever shows the Butler a marker first. Make your offer before the nightcap is served at nine o'clock. Only one of you can be the one. 6. If the Butler sells to you, the Keeper's nightcap waits in a glass on his table in the Merrimack Room. Pour the vial in unseen, then type the short code printed under the glass's coaster into the nightcap box on this page. Only the buyer's code counts, and the page will say only “Noted.” 7. Do your tell, a small habit you no longer notice, at least three times before the nightcap. Do not overdo it. 8. Whoever finishes him takes Cassie's seat and the Veil. You are competing with others you cannot name, and every one of you has the right to try.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- The Farrago ran “massacre” on 1 November 1924 and, in your hearing, the city desk admitted that not one coroner, ambulance or undertaker had been called.
- The Farrago's 1924 society column called it “the Keeper's nine-o'clock rye with honey.”

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- A Boston courier left a ledger page with you in 1925 headed “Roll of Placements”: twenty-two names, seventeen crossed out in a clerk's hand. You kept it and told no one.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- Selling the Farrago outside the cemetery gate in 1925, you counted the new graves of the Veil's people: seventeen. A clerk's note you found said “twenty-two to be placed.”

KEEP CLOSE

- You kept the unprinted line the city desk cut: no coroner, no ambulance.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Sheriff Theodor Farrago: You keep a shoebox with seventeen “accidents” in it and have told no one.

✂ cut out

THE BLACK VEIL · MARKER No. 22

XRTG9

Hand it to the Butler at the bar to buy the vial. Honoured once, by its owner.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil

Butler

BILLS: 12 ($1,200) · **CARRIES:** nothing · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Runs the house, pours the drinks, keeps the secrets. Hears everything, repeats nothing, and holds the keys to every room. **You:** You run the House: the bar, the locks, the tin box that holds the night's takings. You also keep a boarding house on the West Side, which is where a certain lady hid on the night of 31 October 1924 with a bandaged shoulder. Someone paid you $200 to forget her. **You know:** Tim McGinley: supplies the House, and has seen what is under your bar. Leon Gee: you have a message of his you have never delivered. Erika Lamm: a boarder you hid at the House once, and would again, for the right fee.

The Butler: You are the Butler. At the bar you hold the House Tin, the House Book and a single bottle of the House's own tincture for “river rats.” The bottle sells once a night, and only against a numbered marker handed to you by its owner. When a guest offers a marker, open the House panel on your phone, type the five-character code printed on it, and the phone tells you whether to sell. If it says sold, hand over the vial. If it says sold out, hand the marker back. The House counts every offer. Whatever you do, never reveal who bought the tincture until after the body is found. After that, you may sell the answer or keep it: $100 is a fair price. At a quarter past nine you take the Keeper his rye. You will find him. Scream. Nobody takes the marker from you, and you take nothing from anyone: it is all deals, always.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the salt lamp. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the glowing salt lamp. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Sheriff Theodor Farrago's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. Someone is guarding this one, so expect a harder time: a real try still earns half a point. *Seek out: Sheriff Theodor Farrago.* Type: The key word or name.

3. KEEP A SECRET. Your small secret is worth two halves. Let Tiffany Liu of the Lamps earn it from you (half a point), and make sure Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem never does (half a point). You will not be asked anything: it is scored from what they each learn. You may also sell it to anyone for $200 in House bills, but a sale to Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem costs you that half. *Seek out: Tiffany Liu of the Lamps.* Type: In a sentence, how did you manage it? (optional).

4. VIAL. Sell the House's single bottle to the owner of a numbered marker, once, before the nightcap is served at nine o'clock. Record the sale on your House panel. Type: In a sentence, who did you sell to?.

5. HOST TASK. At a quarter past nine, go to the Merrimack Room, find the Keeper and scream. Then tap Claim this point and go to Bartend Joe at the bar for your approval word. Type: The approval word from Bartend Joe.

YOUR RACE: Three trades (+1 to the first to finish)

Collect three trade slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will deal with you. Type the three codes.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- You sell alibis at $100 each, and silence at more.
- You keep the note Cassie left on your pillow in Room 3: “Thank you for the shoulder. — C.” She dots every i with a plain dot, never a ring.
- You knew him the moment he came to the river door on the 22nd: Kit Kessler, the Keeper. He asked for the Merrimack Room, and a rye at nine o'clock.
- His order for tonight: rye, one finger, a spoon of honey, nine o'clock sharp, in the Merrimack Room. You were to bring it.
- Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to hand the House's keys to its new master.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- Every marker carries the number of its owner on the Keeper's List. Markers 18 to 22 never came back to the House.

KEEP CLOSE

- The House whiskey is cold tea, and you took $200 to forget Room 3.
- On 1 November 1924 you took $200 from “Mr. K.” to forget the lady in Room 3. You took it.
- Your boarding-house register still has a page for Room 3 on 31 October 1924: a lady with a bandaged shoulder, and a margin note that “Mr. K.” paid you $200 to forget her.
- Cassie hid in your boarding house on the night of 31 October with a bandaged shoulder. She lived, and left a note on your pillow.
- You alone sell the House's tincture. One bottle, one sale a night, and only against a numbered marker handed to you by its owner at the bar.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Ananya Codru and Charlie Wakem: You once filed a telegram, paid in advance, with no sender.
- About Erika Lamm: You bought a name at the river steps for $20 and were told at least twenty others did too.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Rhea Mallya of Mallya's Emporium

Department store owner

BILLS: 15 ($1,500) · **CARRIES:** nothing · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Everything under one roof, from hats to hatboxes, under a sign that says the customer is always right. The prices say otherwise. **You:** Mallya's Emporium has three floors, a druggist's counter, and a standing account with half this room. You know what everyone buys, which is more than most of them know about themselves. **You know:** Tim McGinley: you stock his gin in the back room under the label of a tonic. Anika Mahns: an unpaid account the size of a small house. Silas Palmer: dresses his band at your counter.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the decoy duck. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the carved wooden duck with a lid. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. LEARN A STORY. Find out what your real job was before you took this cover. The guest named below noticed something about you that a cover cannot hide. *Seek out: Tiffany Liu of the Lamps.* Type: What was your real trade?.

3. LEARN A STORY. Find out what the Keeper did to you: what he took, or who he used to do it. The guest named below saw part of it. Either answer counts. *Seek out: Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor.* Type: What did he do?.

4. LEARN A STORY. The Keeper takes a nightcap at a fixed hour, in a fixed room. Until then the glass on his table is only a glass. Learn the hour, so you know how long you have. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: The hour of his nightcap.

5. VIAL. The House keeps one bottle for those who can pay in a marker. Before the nightcap is served at nine o'clock, take your marker to the Butler at the bar and make your offer. The House counts every offer, whether the answer is yes or no. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: In a sentence, what did the Butler say?.

YOUR RACE: The vial (+1 to the first to finish)

Buy the House's vial from the Butler before anyone else does. The House's own log decides it.

YOUR SECRET: YOU ARE ONE WHO GOT AWAY (Sylvia Ballard, The Milliner)

Who you were: You are Sylvia Ballard, the Black Veil's Milliner and costume mistress: the masks, the gowns and the hats for the masquerade. On 31 October 1924 you dressed the Veil's people for the Exit. A department store is the one place where nobody asks who made the clothes. **How you got away:** You were fitting a gown on Canal Street when the hitman's man came for your girls. You left by the coal cellar with a hatbox and a bolt of silk, and never went back. **Your tell:** You straighten any hat brim you pass, your own or a stranger's, without thinking. **Do it at least three times before the nightcap. What leaks through:** You can name a stitch, a dye lot and a maker at a glance, and you cannot stop pricing what people are wearing.

Your rules: 1. You are one who got away. You know the old man hunted you and the people you trusted, and you know who he is. Others probably escaped too, but you do not know how many or who. Everyone else has been told only that survivors are in the room. Your cover is your public card. Keep it. 2. Your invitation came unsigned, and it knew the new name you have used ever since. Only one person could have known it. Working out who is one of your errands. 3. You carry marker No. 20. It is yours alone: never trade it, never give it away. It is how you pay the House. 4. You have told yourself so many stories since 1925 that you are no longer certain of your real reason for coming. You only know that you must be the one. Somebody in this room saw what he did to you; finding out is one of your errands. 5. The House keeps one bottle of tincture and sells it once a night, to whoever shows the Butler a marker first. Make your offer before the nightcap is served at nine o'clock. Only one of you can be the one. 6. If the Butler sells to you, the Keeper's nightcap waits in a glass on his table in the Merrimack Room. Pour the vial in unseen, then type the short code printed under the glass's coaster into the nightcap box on this page. Only the buyer's code counts, and the page will say only “Noted.” 7. Do your tell, a small habit you no longer notice, at least three times before the nightcap. Do not overdo it. 8. Whoever finishes him takes Cassie's seat and the Veil. You are competing with others you cannot name, and every one of you has the right to try.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- Your emporium's druggist sold the House the last bottle of nux vomica in September. The signature on the poison book: R. Chow.

KEEP CLOSE

- You sold the House its last bottle of nux vomica and rang it up as “river rats” without asking how many.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Anthony Hung, Esq.: You drew name-change papers for a dozen strangers, paid in gold by “a friend,” and kept the carbon.

✂ cut out

THE BLACK VEIL · MARKER No. 20

22RDE

Hand it to the Butler at the bar to buy the vial. Honoured once, by its owner.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Sheriff Theodor Farrago

Sheriff

BILLS: 10 ($1,000) · **CARRIES:** Nuisance Citation, Reply slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: A tin star, a quiet office and a long memory. Knows everyone's business and writes down very little. **You:** You have held the star for six years and your county has never been quiet. A feud with Leon Gee, who mocks your department on the radio every night, has become the best entertainment in the county. **You know:** Leon Gee: you would happily arrest him for being insufferable on the radio, and he knows what that is worth. Emmerich Sunner: the county physician reports to you and examines every body you find. Tiffany Liu: the windows of your office are hers, and so, you suspect, is some of the gossip about you. **Habit:** You check the exits of every room you enter, a lawman's habit. Let people see you do it.

The Sheriff: You are the Sheriff. The law of the night is yours: when the body is found, take charge, tell people to stand back, and keep the scene as you found it. Nothing leaves the room. You hold the Coroner's Folder, sealed until the scream. Open it at the scene. It holds the physician's printed report and a scene code. You hold a Nuisance Citation against Leon Gee, for being insufferable on the radio. You may serve it on him, or you may take a bribe from a go-between and tear it up. Either way, the choice is yours. You may question anyone. Nobody has to answer, and the host will not rule on what they say. What you learn is yours to trade.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the Eighteenth Amendment. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the pocket Constitution. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. DEAL. You hold a Nuisance Citation against Leon Gee for being insufferable. Take a bribe from a go-between and tear the citation up: the go-between hands you a Pardon slip. Type the code on the slip. *Seek out: Leon Gee of WFEA.* Type: The code on the Pardon slip.

3. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Krrish Vermouth's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. Someone is guarding this one, so expect a harder time: a real try still earns half a point. *Seek out: Krrish Vermouth.* Type: The key word or name.

4. KEEP A SECRET. Your small secret is worth two halves. Let Anthony Hung, Esq. earn it from you (half a point), and make sure Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil never does (half a point). You will not be asked anything: it is scored from what they each learn. You may also sell it to anyone for $200 in House bills, but a sale to Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil costs you that half. *Seek out: Anthony Hung, Esq..* Type: In a sentence, how did you manage it? (optional).

5. HOST TASK. When the body is found, take charge, question the room, and make an arrest by a quarter past ten. Then tap Claim this point and go to Bartend Joe at the bar for your approval word. Type: The approval word from Bartend Joe.

YOUR RACE: Three witnesses (+1 to the first to finish)

Collect three witness slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Reply slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- Between December 1924 and September 1925 seventeen people with no records and no families died in “accidents” in your county: a fire, a fall, a drowning, an aeroplane. You never found a link.
- His register of every gun he has sold has never once been shown to you for a licence check, and he can name any customer's face after one look.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- You counted seventeen “accidents.” A clerk's note you found says “twenty-two to be placed.” Five are unaccounted for.
- Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to swear a man in. It did not say who.
- On 15 September 1925 a man named Ignatius Bell was shot in a “brawl” at a Granite Street shed. Nobody claimed his body.
- Three of your 1925 “accidents” were runners who carried messages for the Veil; the last drowned in the river and the coroner said accident. The girl who ran with them was never found.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- You hold the Coroner's Folder, sealed until the body is found. Inside is the physician's printed report.

KEEP CLOSE

- You keep a shoebox with seventeen “accidents” in it and have told no one.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Arjun Bat: You hauled bricks in 1921 for a wall in the Merrimack Room that is too thick.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Sidd Airwind

Barnstormer

BILLS: 14 ($1,400) · **CARRIES:** Witness slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Flies from town to town in a patched-up plane, selling rides and thrills to anyone with a dollar. Has seen every field in New England from above, and doesn't much like the ground. **You:** You barnstorm the county's fairs and carry mail when the roads are mud. You are always the first to ask which way the door is, and the last to say why. **You know:** Krrish Vermouth: ships you the vermouth you pour over the fairgrounds on a good day. Tiffany Liu: sold you a lamp for your hangar, and a story for it. Leon Gee: reads your weather on the air, wrongly. **Habit:** You glance at your wristwatch every time a door opens, a flier's habit. Do it whenever someone comes or goes.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. MONEY. Sell rides in your plane to anyone with a dollar. Leave with at least $2,000. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them. Type: Dollars in your pocket at the end.

2. FIND. Find the route globe. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the lit globe on its stand. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

3. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Judge Eric Leeway's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. Someone is guarding this one, so expect a harder time: a real try still earns half a point. *Seek out: Judge Eric Leeway.* Type: The key word or name.

4. LEARN A STORY. A wall in the Merrimack Room hides something. Learn what, from those who built or swept it. *Seek out: Adam Holdsfire.* Type: What it hides.

5. LEARN A STORY. Seventeen strangers died in accidents in one county. Learn the count from someone who counted. *Seek out: Sheriff Theodor Farrago.* Type: The number.

YOUR RACE: The reply (+1 to the first to finish)

Bring back three reply slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Witness slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- Dr. Sunner dots his i's with a tiny ring, as you saw on the prescription for your airsickness. Every prescription clerk in the county was taught to, and his diploma is genuine.
- Erika has sat facing the door of every hangar you ever hid her in. It is a fugitive's habit, and everybody knows it.
- At the aerodrome the Sheriff checks every exit before he will stand beside a plane. A lawman's habit.
- She read your logbook upside down across the table and corrected your arithmetic. A courier learns to read anything from any side.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- Last winter you flew a woman with a stiff shoulder and a veil to a field outside Boston, no questions asked. She paid in gold and signed the logbook with a plain C.
- A flier who barnstormed the Granite Street fairground that fall heard that Ignatius Bell, who held the second door at the Veil, was shot in the shed behind it, and that the big man who worked the other door was never found.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- Your black envelope was on House stock, signed only “The House.” The man who used to write the House's notes had a stiff hand, and so did this one.

KEEP CLOSE

- You trained a mechanic who was later paid to be careless once.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor: You wear your father's brass key on a ribbon under your collar and have never once tried it in a lock.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Silas Palmer of the Palm Court

Jazz scat singer

BILLS: 12 ($1,200) · **CARRIES:** request card, Trade slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Sings the words nobody wrote, ba-doo-be-da and all, and leads the band that keeps the floor moving. **You:** You lead the band at the Palm Court and sing the scat that carries over any room. The papers like you; the booking agents like you more, because you never ask to be paid in anything but cash. **You know:** Leon Gee: broadcasts your records on WFEA, and says the scat reminds him of someone. Anika Mahns: a patron of the band, and not one who explains herself. Luke Shelldon: books your orchestra for the carnival. **Habit:** You tip your hat to everyone you pass and set it straight by the brim afterward, a bandleader's courtesy. Do it at every greeting.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. MONEY. Sing for your supper, and pass the hat. Leave with at least $1,800. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them. Type: Dollars in your pocket at the end.

2. FIND. Find the opera bill. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the Falstaff poster in the hall. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

3. DEAL. Anika Mahns wants to know who in this room knew her father. Take her $30 voucher, play her father's signature tune around half past eight, and call it a request from the room. Hand her the request card and keep the voucher: read its code. Nobody is to know. *Seek out: Anika Mahns of Mahns Manor.* Type: The code on the voucher.

4. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Judge Eric Leeway's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. *Seek out: Judge Eric Leeway.* Type: The key word or name.

5. HOST TASK. Around half past eight, take the floor for five minutes, with the band or without it. When you have finished, tap Claim this point and go to Bartend Joe at the bar for your approval word. Type: The approval word from Bartend Joe.

YOUR RACE: The reply (+1 to the first to finish)

Bring back three reply slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Trade slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- Before every set in 1924 the Keeper sent the band a note: nothing louder than a whisper at nine o'clock, when he took his rye with honey.
- "The veil lifts" was Cassie's own toast to the band every closing night. You would know it anywhere, even in a stranger's hand on an unsigned card.
- She priced your tails to the penny from across the room and told you where your tailor had cut a corner.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- At your table he copied a signature onto a napkin so exactly that you could not tell it from the original, then burned it, laughing. A hand like that is a trade, not a hobby.
- The girls who sewed the band's costumes were killed one by one that winter. You asked the costume mistress to dress the band again; she had vanished.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to play the Veil's old fanfare. Nobody has played it since 1924.

KEEP CLOSE

- You have sung the same scat phrase at every club since 1921, and it was Cassie's own call.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Leon Gee of WFEA: You once read the Sheriff's private mail aloud on the air by mistake, and he has never forgiven it.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Tiffany Liu of the Lamps

Stained-glass artist

BILLS: 10 ($1,000) · **CARRIES:** earring, Pardon slip, go-between's receipt, Trade slip (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: Turns broken glass into lamps and windows people stop and stare at. Everything made here glows a little like a secret. **You:** You have your own glass studio and a loupe you never leave behind. Your lamps hang in the Sheriff's office and your windows hang in the churches, and you have cut a brass plate or two for the Veil itself. **You know:** Leon Gee: a neighbour in the glass, who reads the Sheriff's mail aloud and your lamps' prices with equal pleasure. Joshua Kamin-Sky: reads the glass you make. Theodor Farrago: the Sheriff's office windows are yours.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. FIND. Find the glowing bottle. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the lit-up wine bottle. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

2. SWAP. Strike a bargain with Joshua Kamin-Sky: your earring for their soothsayer's charm. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag. *Seek out: Joshua Kamin-Sky.* Type: The code on the tag you received.

3. DEAL. Take at least $100 in House bills from Leon Gee and carry a Pardon slip to Sheriff Farrago. If he takes it, he tears up his citation and hands it to you: read the code on the torn citation. Give Leon a go-between's receipt. *Seek out: Sheriff Theodor Farrago.* Type: The code on the torn citation.

4. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. *Seek out: Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil.* Type: The key word or name.

5. KEEP A SECRET. Your small secret is worth two halves. Let Arjun Bat earn it from you (half a point), and make sure Joshua Kamin-Sky never does (half a point). You will not be asked anything: it is scored from what they each learn. You may also sell it to anyone for $200 in House bills, but a sale to Joshua Kamin-Sky costs you that half. *Seek out: Arjun Bat.* Type: In a sentence, how did you manage it? (optional).

YOUR RACE: Three tools (+1 to the first to finish)

Gather three tool tokens from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will hand it to you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Trade slip: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- You cut the brass plate on the Veil's register: "KEEPER · K.K." You know whose initials those are: Kit Kessler's.
- Every handbill the barker paints has a tiny ring over each i, and when he signs for a delivery he taps his pen twice afterward, as if sealing it.
- She asked who cut your apron, and named the maker and the dye lot at a glance.
- He moved his chair twice tonight, until he could see the door.
- The Sheriff counts the windows and the doors of every room before he sits. You hung his office windows; he checked them for exits first.
- Sidd checks his wristwatch every time a door opens. A flier counts minutes by habit and has done since the war.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- Your invitation carried a private line from the House: be ready at half past nine to engrave a seal. It did not say for whom.

KEEP CLOSE

- You cut the brass plate "KEEPER · K.K." and your chisel slipped on the second K.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About J. Bruce Wayne: Your "office" is the back room of a hat shop, and the Keeper once used its telephone to call Boston.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.

Tim McGinley, Baron of Bathtub Gin

Gin baron

BILLS: 15 ($1,500) · **CARRIES:** jar of bathtub gin, Tool token (keep on you) · **ANSWERS:** on your phone, closes 10:30

WHO YOU ARE

The room sees: The finest gin in Manchester comes out of the biggest bathtub, delivered with a smile and no questions. **You:** You are in your second year of going straight, which means your gin now has a license plate. You ran the launch at the foot of the river steps in 1924 and have been trying to forget what you saw. **You know:** Rebecca Chow: the House's Butler; you supply the House, and what it does not know about your gin is little. Rhea Mallya: stocks your gin in the Emporium's back room under the label of a tonic. Anthony Hung: your lawyer; you do not pay him on time.

YOUR FIVE OBJECTIVES (1 point each)

1. MONEY. A baron's business is the margin. Sell, trade and bargain. Leave with at least $2,100. Count your bills at the end and submit the total. Bartend Joe may ask to see them. Type: Dollars in your pocket at the end.

2. FIND. Find the launch's fog horn. It stays where it is, in a shared room, with a small black tag taped on or beside it. Look for the conch shell. Read the tag and type its code. Type: The code on the tag.

3. SWAP. Strike a bargain with Arjun Bat: your jar of bathtub gin for their lucky ball. It must be a deal, never a grab. When you hold it, read the code on its tag. *Seek out: Arjun Bat.* Type: The code on the tag you received.

4. LEARN A SECRET. Everyone has something they would rather not say. Learn Diwakar Sandbagg's small secret, not by being told it is a secret, but by earning it. Someone is guarding this one, so expect a harder time: a real try still earns half a point. *Seek out: Diwakar Sandbagg.* Type: The key word or name.

5. KEEP A SECRET. Your small secret is worth two halves. Let Erika Lamm earn it from you (half a point), and make sure Diwakar Sandbagg never does (half a point). You will not be asked anything: it is scored from what they each learn. You may also sell it to anyone for $200 in House bills, but a sale to Diwakar Sandbagg costs you that half. *Seek out: Erika Lamm.* Type: In a sentence, how did you manage it? (optional).

YOUR RACE: Three trades (+1 to the first to finish)

Collect three trade slips from three different guests. Five guests are carrying them: ask around, and whoever has one will deal with you. Type the three codes. **You carry for others:** Tool token: hand it to anyone who asks for it by name.

WHAT YOU KNOW (tell, trade or sell as marked)

SAY FREELY

- The House keeps a bottle of “rat tincture” under the bar for the river rats. You have seen the Butler lock it away: one sale a night, markers only.
- You have lost to Angelos at cards since 1919. The way he counts chips with his thumb is just the trade.
- She once walked from the river steps to Elm Street in four minutes by streets that are not on any map. A courier's trick.

TRADE IT (a line for a line)

- You ran the launch the night of 31 October and saw a woman with a bandaged shoulder pull herself out of the water at the foot of the river steps, alive, while the Keeper's car drove away without her.
- At the druggist's in September you saw R. Chow of the House sign the poison book for four ounces of nux vomica tincture, “for river rats.”
- The launch fare for the vault advance was paid out of “the Teller's share.” Later you learned that same share paid the hitman.
- That winter the Veil's runners died one at a time. The last was thrown into the river off the Granite Street steps, and the boatman who did it bragged that it was paid for out of the other runner's own share.

COSTS $100 AT THE BAR (drop a bill in the House Tin first)

- Your invitation was on House stock, signed only “The House,” and posted from Boston. The House has not written to you since 1924, and you owe it a favour you have been dreading.

KEEP CLOSE

- Two passengers went down the river steps that night; one came back alone with blood on his cuff.
- You ran the launch at the foot of the river steps that night. Two passengers went down the stairs; one came back alone with blood on his cuff and told you to forget the second. You have not forgotten.

ENTRUSTED SECRETS (another guest's small secret, held for them)

- About Dr. Emmerich Sunner: You ate beet sandwiches for a week to prove the “blood” was beets and sugar.
- About Rebecca Chow, Butler of the Black Veil: The House whiskey is cold tea, and you took $200 to forget Room 3.

The town's story is on the door poster and your phone. Bartend Joe gives the word for any HOST TASK once he has seen it done. At the end, count your bills and type the total.